

● HARD

● PROBLEM-SOLVING AND DATA ANALYSIS

● ANSWER KEY

Evaluating statistical claims: Observational studies and experiments

01

6 answers · Rationale-rich · Teach from doc

Q1**B**

B. All fourth-grade students at the school

Choice B is correct. Selecting a sample of a reasonable size at random to use for a survey allows the results from that survey to be applied to the population from which the sample was selected, but not beyond this population. In this case, the population from which the sample was selected is all fourth-grade students at a certain school. Therefore, the results of the survey can be applied to all fourth-grade students at the school.

Choice A is incorrect. The results of the survey can be applied to the 40 students who were surveyed. However, this isn't the largest group to which the results of the survey can be applied. Choices C and D are incorrect. Since the sample was selected at random from among the fourth-grade students at a certain school, the results of the survey can't be applied to other students at the school or to other fourth-grade students who weren't represented in the survey results. Students in other grades in the school or other fourth-grade students in the country may feel differently about announcements than the fourth-grade students at the school.

Q2**C**

C. The sampling method is flawed and may produce a biased estimate of the mean number of children per household in the community.

Choice C is correct. In order to use a sample mean to estimate the mean for a population, the sample must be representative of the population (for example, a simple random sample). In this case, Tabitha surveyed 20 families in a playground. Families in the playground are more likely to have children than other households in the community. Therefore, the sample isn't representative of the population. Hence, the sampling method is flawed and may produce a biased estimate.

Choices A and D are incorrect because they incorrectly assume the sampling method is unbiased. Choice B is incorrect because a sample of size 20 could be large enough to make an estimate if the sample had been representative of all the families in the community.

Q3

D

D. All the baobab trees that were 17 years old in this habitat

Choice D is correct. When a study uses a randomly selected sample, the largest group to which the results of the study can be applied is the population from which the sample was selected. It's given that the scientist randomly selected the trees from the baobab trees in a certain habitat that were 17 years old. Therefore, the largest group to which the results of this study can be applied is all the baobab trees that were 17 years old in this habitat.

Choice A is incorrect. Since the sample was randomly selected from a population, the results can be applied to a larger group than the sample.

Choice B is incorrect. The sample was selected from a population of baobab trees that were 17 years old, not 19 years old.

Choice C is incorrect. The sample was selected from a certain tree habitat in South Africa, not from all the baobab trees that were 17 years old in South Africa.

Q4

B

B. All students at the school

Choice B is correct. The largest group to which the results of a study can be generalized is the population from which the random sample was chosen. In this case, the psychologist chose a random sample from all students at one particular middle school. Therefore, the largest group to which the results can be generalized is all the students at the school.

Choice A is incorrect because this isn't the largest group the results can be generalized to. Choices C and D are incorrect because these groups are larger than the population from which the random sample was chosen. Therefore, the sample isn't representative of these groups.

Q5

D

D. All trivia teams in the tournament

Choice D is correct. It's given that the organizer selected 55 teams at random from all trivia teams in the tournament. A table is also given displaying the information for the 40 teams in the sample that practiced for at least 3 hours per week. Selecting a sample of a reasonable size at random to use for a survey allows the results from that survey to be applied to the population from which the sample was selected, but not beyond this population. Thus, only the sampling method information is necessary to determine the largest population to which the results of the study can be generalized. Since the organizer selected the sample at random from all trivia teams in the tournament, the largest population to which the results of the study can be generalized is all trivia teams in the tournament.

Choice A is incorrect. The sample was selected at random from all trivia teams in the tournament, not just from the teams that scored an average of 14 or more points per round.

Choice B is incorrect. If a study uses a sample selected at random from a population, the results of the study can be generalized to the population, not just the sample.

Choice C is incorrect. If a study uses a sample selected at random from a population, the results of the study can be generalized to the population, not just a subset of the sample.

Q6

B

- B. Those who responded to the poll were not a random sample of the population of the United States.
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Choice B is correct. In order for the poll results from a sample of a population to represent the entire population, the sample must be representative of the population. A sample that is randomly selected from a population is more likely than a sample of the type described to represent the population. In this case, the people who responded were people with access to cable television and websites, which aren't accessible to the entire population. Moreover, the people who responded also chose to watch the show and respond to the poll. The people who made these choices aren't representative of the entire population of the United States because they were not a random sample of the population of the United States.

Choices A, C, and D are incorrect because they present reasons unrelated to whether the sample is representative of the population of the United States.

Notes

Accept equivalent forms (e.g. $0.25 \equiv 1/4$). For grid-in items, decimal and fraction answers are both valid.

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